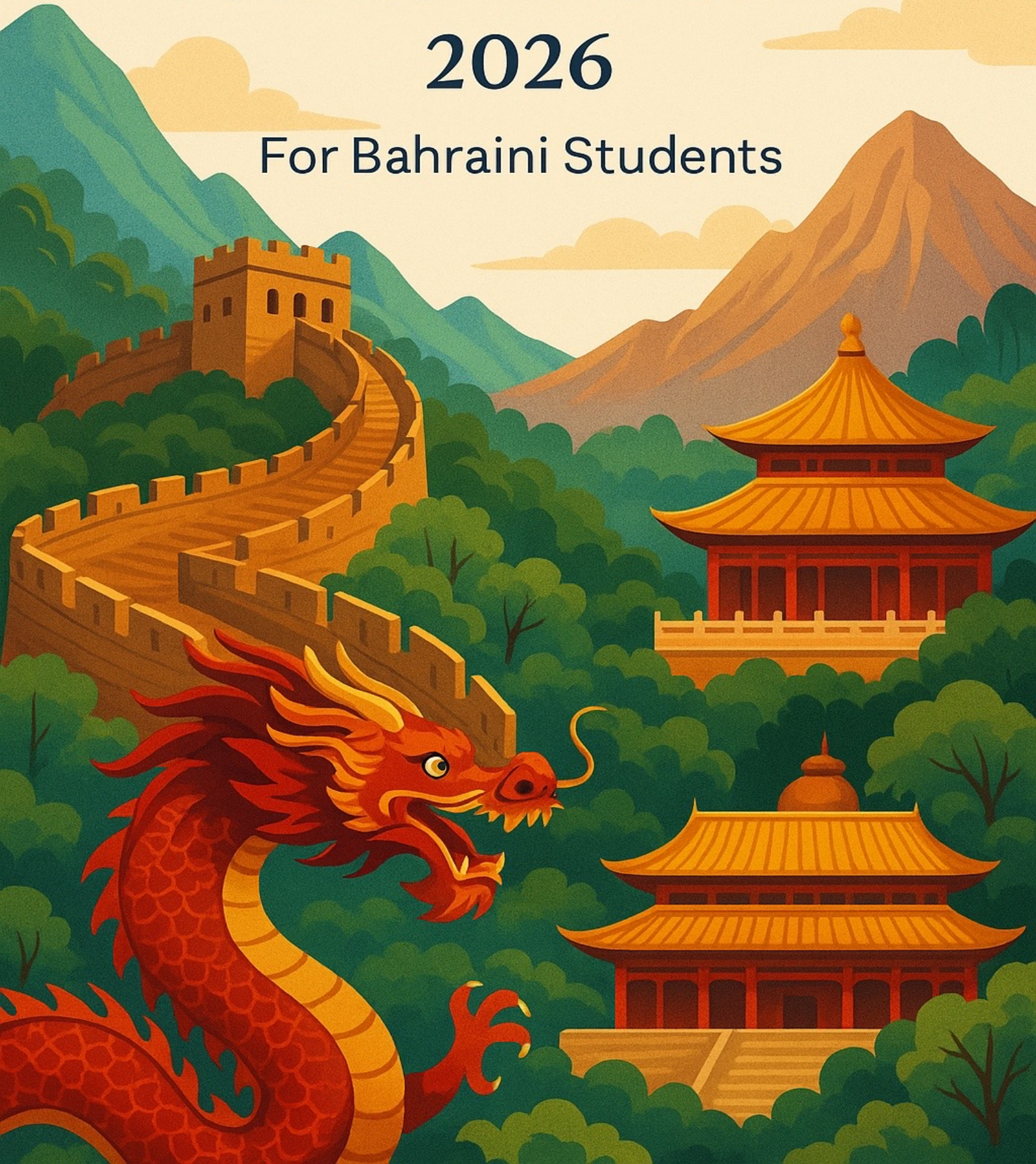


China Student Guide 2026

For Bahraini Students



Handbook of Guidance for Bahraini Students in China

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The Cultural Counselor's Welcome Message

Dear Students of the Kingdom of Bahrain in the People's Republic of China,

It gives me immense pride and honor to welcome you in my capacity as the Cultural Counselor of the Cultural Division Office at the Embassy of the Kingdom of Bahrain in Beijing. You are not only students you are ambassadors of Bahrain, carrying with you the values of our nation as you pursue knowledge and excellence in one of the world's oldest civilizations and fastest-growing educational landscapes.

The Cultural Office represents the Kingdom of Bahrain's Ministry of Education in China. Our mission is to safeguard your academic path, support your personal well-being, and strengthen bridges of understanding between Bahrain and the People's Republic of China through education, culture, and mutual respect.

China offers you an extraordinary experience: a land of deep traditions, modern innovations, and world-class universities. This journey will transform your future if you embrace it with discipline, resilience, and curiosity. You may face challenges, cultural differences, language barriers, or the rigor of academic life but remember that such challenges are also opportunities to grow stronger, more independent, and more accomplished.

Above all, always remember **you are not alone**. The Cultural Division Office is your home away from home. Our duty is to stand by your side in every stage of your studies from your first day in China until your proud graduation providing guidance, assistance, and care.

We strongly remind you that registering with the Cultural Office is not optional but essential. It ensures that we can support you, protect you, and keep you connected with your Embassy family here in Beijing. Your safety, success, and dignity are at the heart of our mission.

As you embark on this exciting journey, uphold the reputation of Bahrain through your actions, studies, and conduct. Carry our values with pride and let your achievements be a reflection of the bright future you are helping to build for our beloved Kingdom.

On behalf of the Embassy of the Kingdom of Bahrain in Beijing, I wish you every success in your studies, every joy in your discoveries, and every strength in your challenges. May your years in China be filled with learning, growth, and memorable experiences that will remain with you for life.

With my highest regards,

Bader S. AlJalahma
Cultural Counselor
Embassy of the Kingdom of Bahrain – Beijing

The Higher Education System in the People's Republic of China

China's higher education system is one of the largest and fastest developing in the world, governed centrally by the Ministry of Education (MOE). It is built on a three-tier academic framework: bachelor's, master's, and doctoral degrees, all regulated by the Academic Degrees Law of the People's Republic of China.

Structure and Classification

Chinese universities and colleges fall into three main categories:

1. Comprehensive universities offering a broad range of disciplines (e.g., Peking University, Tsinghua University).
2. Technical and engineering institutions focusing on applied sciences, information technology, and innovation.
3. Specialized universities devoted to medicine, foreign languages, economics, arts, or teacher training.

Academic Degrees

- Master's degrees usually require 2–3 years of study and involve coursework, research, and a thesis.
- Doctoral degrees normally extend over 4–6 years, emphasizing independent research and publication.
Each degree can be academic (research-oriented) or professional (practice-oriented).

Language of Instruction

While Mandarin Chinese remains the primary language, an increasing number of postgraduate programs are taught entirely in English, particularly in engineering, business, and medical sciences. Students enrolling in Chinese-taught programs must present HSK Level 5–6, whereas English-taught programs require IELTS or TOEFL scores.

Quality and Internationalization

China's government actively promotes international standards through the "Double First-Class University Initiative (双一流)", which designates leading institutions and disciplines for global excellence. This initiative replaced the former Project 985 and Project 211 and currently includes over 140 universities.

Postgraduate Admissions

Admission is highly competitive and merit based. Applicants must submit certified transcripts, recommendation letters, and a research proposal (for PhD studies). Each university has an international admissions office responsible for evaluating foreign credentials.

Funding Opportunities

Foreign students may apply for several scholarships:

- Chinese Government Scholarship (CSC) – full coverage of tuition, housing, stipend, and insurance.
- Provincial and Municipal Scholarships – partial support by local governments (e.g., Beijing, Shanghai).
- University-specific Fellowships – offered to outstanding international students.

Oversight and Quality Assurance

The MOE, in coordination with the China Academic Degrees and Graduate Education Development Center (CDGDC), supervises accreditation, curriculum standards, and recognition of degrees. Graduate qualifications are digitally recorded on CHSI (China Higher Education Student Information Platform), which serves as the official verification database for all graduates.

Summary

China's postgraduate education system is research-driven, highly structured, and internationally competitive. It provides rich opportunities for Bahraini students seeking world-class academic training in science, engineering, business, and cultural studies, within an environment that increasingly values innovation, global exchange, and technological advancement.

Before Admission to Any Chinese University

Pre-Application Guidance:

- Use platforms such as CUCAS or Study in China to explore available programs.
- Check global university rankings and consult the Cultural Office in Beijing for advice.

Application Steps:

- Choose the university and the program you wish to pursue.
- Complete the online application form.
- Upload translated and certified academic documents as required.
- Pay the application fee.
- Receive the official Admission Letter and the JW202 form.
- Apply for a student visa (X1/X2) using the above documents.

Required Documents:

- Valid passport.
- Translated and notarized academic certificates.
- Health check report.
- Passport-sized photographs.
- Recommendation letters (for postgraduate applicants).
- Personal statement.
- Language proficiency certificate (IELTS or TOEFL).

Final Registration Upon Arrival in China:

- Submit the original documents to the admissions office.
- Undergo a health check in China.
- Pay the tuition fees and collect your student ID card.

Scholarships Available for Bahraini Students

1) General Information

- The Chinese Government Scholarship (CGS/CSC) is the principal national scholarship scheme. Applications are usually open from December to April, but the exact deadlines vary depending on the country and the university.
 - Type A – Embassy Route: Applications are submitted through the Chinese Embassy or Consulate in The Kingdom of Bahrain. Deadlines here are usually around February.
 - Type B – University Route: Applications are made directly through the Chinese university of your choice (in addition to the CSC portal). Deadlines often extend until March (sometimes April, depending on the university).
 - Type C – Cooperation/Agreement Scholarships: These are offered under specific agreements between China and international organizations, partner institutions, or particular government programs. Deadlines and procedures depend on the terms of the individual cooperation program.
- All applicants must complete the official CSC online application via www.campuschina.org / www.studyinchina.csc.edu.cn. In addition, some universities may require a parallel application through their own admissions system.

2) Main CSC Categories

- Type A – Bilateral/Embassy Route: Apply via your local Chinese Embassy/Consulate (the “dispatching authority”). Timeline and quotas are set by The People’s Republic of China Embassy.
- Type B – Chinese University Program: Apply directly to the University (plus the CSC portal). Universities set their own cut-offs; many advise completing by mid of December for competitive programs.
- Application limits: The rules may vary depending on the year and the issuing agency. In some cases, applicants are allowed to apply to only one University under the Type B route. In other cases, multiple University applications are permitted; however, you can only be nominated by one University at the end. Always check and follow the latest instructions provided by the University or the Embassy before applying.

3) Coverage (CSC)

- Tuition: full waiver.
- Accommodation: on-campus dorm or allowance if off-campus (typically RMB 700/month for undergrad/master’s; RMB 1,000/month for PhD).
- Monthly stipend (typical): RMB 2,500 (Undergraduate), RMB 3,000 (Master’s), RMB 3,500 (PhD).
- Comprehensive medical insurance (often RMB 800/year).

4) Required Documents (typical)

- Valid passport.
- Translated and notarised academic certificates and transcripts.
- Recommendation letters (postgraduate only).
- Study Plan / Personal Statement.
- Language proficiency: HSK (Chinese-taught) or IELTS/TOEFL (English-taught), as required.
- Any university-specific forms and health check per the notice.

5) Municipal / Provincial Scholarships (examples)

- Beijing Government Scholarship (BGS): Tuition-focused awards managed via eligible Beijing universities; cannot be held simultaneously with CGS. Coverage and duration vary by degree level.
- Shanghai Government Scholarship (SGS):
 - Class A (Full): tuition, medical insurance, on-campus accommodation, and stipend (often RMB 3,000/month for master's; RMB 3,500/month for PhD).
 - Class B (Partial): tuition + medical insurance (no stipend).

6) Practical Tips (to maximize success)

- Pre-admission/Acceptance from the university strongly helps Type B nominations as many universities explicitly encourage it.
- Watch individual university deadlines (some close as early as mid-Dec for Type B).
- Keep one consistent name/passport across all systems to avoid CHSI/verification issues later (align with admissions & CSC entries). (Procedural best-practice; aligns with typical university/CSC requirements.)

Arrival in China and University Registration

1) At the Airport

- Follow the “Arrivals / Immigration” signs.
- Fill out the Arrival Card (usually given on the plane or available before the passport control line).
- Passport Control:
 - Keep your passport and student visa in your hand.
 - Have both printed and digital copies of your Admission Letter and Accommodation Address (hotel or dorm). The officer may ask to see them.
- Baggage Claim: Collect your luggage.
- Customs: If you have nothing to declare, use the Green Channel.
- Before leaving the airport:
 - Make sure your phone is charged.
 - Keep all important papers in one folder.
 - Have your university address written in English and Chinese.

Tip: Put these items in your hand luggage: passport, visa, admission letter, accommodation details, 4–6 passport photos, phone + charger, some cash (RMB or USD), and a working bank card.

2) Mobile SIM, Internet & Connectivity (Critical)

A. Prepaid SIM Card (预付费卡)

- Best for: Immediate use on Day 1, short-term stay, or as a starter plan.
- How it works: You load money first, then use the credit. Top up via cash, Alipay, WeChat Pay, or in carrier shops.
- Pros: Easy to buy, quick activation with just your passport, no commitment.
- Cons: Higher cost per GB, balance must be topped up regularly.
- What to say in English: “I need a prepaid SIM card with lots of data.”
- In Chinese: 我要办理预付费手机卡，需要大流量。

B. Postpaid / Billing SIM Card (后付费卡)

- Best for: Students staying long-term (two plus years).
- How it works: You sign a monthly contract. Payment is charged automatically each month, usually through a Chinese bank account or linked to WeChat/Alipay.
- Requirements:
 - Passport and valid student visa/residence permit.
 - A Chinese bank account (usually opened after registration at the university).
- Pros: Cheaper in the long run, stable unlimited data plans, no need to recharge.
- Cons: Harder to set up in your first days if you don't yet have a residence permit or bank account.
- What to say in English: “I want to apply for a monthly billing SIM card”
- In Chinese: 我要办理后付费手机卡，需要无限流量。

C. Recommended Student Sequence

1. Day 1 (Arrival): Buy a prepaid SIM with your passport then get your Chinese phone number and after that set up WeChat and Alipay immediately.
2. After you get your residence permit plus your bank account: Return to the carrier shop and switch to a postpaid/billing plan. Your number will stay the same.

D. Accessing International Apps

- Many popular services (Google, Gmail, YouTube, WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, X/Twitter, Dropbox, etc.) are restricted in mainland China.
- To use them, you need a reliable VPN:
 - Before arrival: Install and configure VPN apps (e.g., Astrill VPN, LetsVPN) on your mobile phone, iPad and laptop.
 - Keep at least 2 options in case one fails.
 - Important: VPNs are regulated in China. Use them responsibly and follow local laws and your university's rules.
- **Tip:** Do not change your Apple ID or Google Play region to China. Some apps may disappear. Keep your account region as Bahrain/US/UK to continue receiving updates.

E. Roaming or Travel eSIM (Temporary Option)

- Roaming with your home SIM card may work when you first land, and in some cases, it can even bypass restrictions on apps and websites. However, this option is extremely expensive and not reliable for long-term use. Treat it only as a bridge for your first day until your Chinese SIM card is active.
- Important note about eSIM in China:
 - **Mainland China does not allow eSIM** for regular consumers. Local carriers (China Mobile, China Unicom, China Telecom) issue only physical SIM cards.
 - If your current phone in Bahrain only supports eSIM (and does not have a SIM tray), you will not be able to use a Chinese SIM card.
 - In that case, you would need to buy a new phone in China with a SIM tray, which means extra cost and hassle.
- What to do before you arrive:
 - Check your phone carefully: Make sure it has a SIM tray for physical SIM cards.
 - If you are currently using eSIM in Bahrain, make sure your phone also has a physical SIM slot ready for the Chinese SIM card.
 - If your device is eSIM-only (for example, some newer iPhones in Bahrain), consider switching to a dual-SIM model or carrying a backup phone with a SIM tray before coming to China.

F. First-Day Connectivity Checklist

- ☒ Buy and activate a local SIM with your passport.
- ☒ Log in to WeChat application (you'll need the SMS activation code).
- ☒ Log in to Alipay application (for payments and many important services).
- ☒ Use VPN only when needed for restricted apps (turn it off when not needed).
- ☒ Ask about student packages as many universities cooperate with China Mobile Unicom to offer exclusive deals for students.

3) Health Check

- Ask your International Students Office or International Students Services ISS where to do the health check (on campus or at a designated hospital/clinic).
- Bring: passport, admission letter, passport photos, and payment method.
- Typical tests: height, weight, blood pressure, blood test, and chest X-ray.
- Collect and keep:
 - Receipts,
 - Medical report (Foreigner Physical Examination Record).
- You will need these later to apply for your Residence Permit.

Tip: Wear simple clothes (no metal jewelry for X-ray).

4) Final University Registration

- Go to the Admissions or International Students Office or the ISS.
- Bring original documents plus copies of the following:
 - Passport and visa,
 - Admission letter,
 - Health check report,
 - Passport photos,
 - Scholarship or financial documents (if any).
- Steps you will usually complete:
 1. Identity check with passport.
 2. Document submission (admission, medical, photos).
 3. Tuition payment (if not on scholarship) and receipt collection.
 4. Receive Student ID Card (needed for library, dorms, cafeteria, etc.).
 5. Get your campus login (email, Wi-Fi, portal).
 6. Learn how to check into your dormitory or confirm you're housing.
- Residence Registration: Within 24 hours of moving in, your address must be registered.
 - Hotels and dorms usually do this automatically.
 - If you live in an apartment, you may need to go to the local police station with your landlord.
- Residence Permit Application: Must be done (usually within 30 days of arrival). The university will guide you step by step if not ask your academic advisor or the ISS.

5) Important Notes

- Try to arrive at least one week before classes begin to finish all steps comfortably.
- Keep digital copies of all documents on your phone or iPad and cloud storage.
- Payments in China are mostly via WeChat Pay application and Alipay application. Set these up early as instructed earlier upon arrival.
- Some universities provide airport pick-up services. Confirm in advance.
- If you face problems, go directly to the International Students Services ISS or Office they are your best support.

Changing Your Major in China (for International Students)

The big picture (what's actually allowed)

- National rule: After you enroll, you can apply to change your major, but each university sets its own conditions, windows, and process.
- Reality on campus: Some schools are open (clear windows, tests, GPA rules); others say “not allowed in principle” but permit exceptions with high bars. Majors like medicine, arts/sports or quota-tight programs often impose extra restrictions.
- CSC/Chinese Government Scholarship: In principle you cannot change majors (or study period). If truly necessary, it requires formal approval (often from your embassy plus university plus CSC). Otherwise, the scholarship can be canceled and terminated.

Two different paths

A) Change major

Within the same University

(most common)

- Typical timing: end of Year one or Year two (many schools limit it to these windows).
- Typical requirements:
 - Good standing (no fails/disciplinary record).
 - GPA/credit bar set by the target department (e.g., $GPA \geq 3.0$ or pass a subject test/interview).
 - Seats available in the receiving major.
 - Language: for Chinese-taught programs, the HSK bar may be higher than at entry.
- Paperwork/process (**common pattern**):
 1. Consult early with the International Office ISS plus both departments (current/target).
 2. Submit the “Change of Major” form plus transcript plus plan; both departments sign off; then the ISS/Teaching Affairs gives final approval.
 3. Entrance test/interview if required (STEM often tests math; humanities often English/Chinese interview).
 4. Credit mapping: what will transfer, what won't, and whether you'll drop back a cohort (延后一届) to catch up.
 5. Student status update posted by the university (you'll see internal notices/lists during the window).

B) Transfer to another University

(hard/rare)

- Many schools explicitly say “generally not allowed”; only special conditions with multiple approvals. CSC students additionally need CSC's written consent. Expect a fresh admission plus new paperwork.

Medical, Business, Engineering, Art: crossing fields (what to expect)

- Medicine to Business / Engineering to Art (cross-college): expect testing plus portfolio/audition where relevant; some destination majors won't accept cross-category transfers (e.g., arts/sports tracks).
- You may need extra semesters: credits rarely line up one-to-one across distant fields; plan for a longer study length.

Visas, permits, and records (don't skip!)

- Within the same university: your Residence Permit (study) usually stays valid, but if any item on your permit/records changes, local rules can require you to update with Exit-Entry in a set number of days—your International Office will advise.
- Transferring to another university/city: you must update police registration and Exit-Entry documents per local rules. Do this promptly to avoid penalties.
- CHSI (national degree database): after your transfer is approved, make sure your student-status/major is correct in CHSI to avoid recognition problems later.

Step-by-step: changing major

Within your university

T-90 to T-60 days before the window opens

1. Quiet research: read your school's latest policy (dates, GPA/test, forms). (Examples show: fixed spring windows; one chance "in principle".)
2. Reality check with target department: courses you must catch up on; likely grade-level; seat limits.
3. Scholarship holders: ask your International Office the ISS if your funding permits a major change. CSC students: assume not allowed unless you obtain formal written approval.

Application window (often Year-end/Semester-end)

4. File the form plus transcript plus statement of purpose (plus portfolio/test if needed).
5. Sit the exam/interview (if any). Results plus seat availability determine offers.
6. Receive decisions; if conditional, keep all courses passed (unpassed courses can void transfer offers).

After approval

7. Credit mapping in writing (what transfers, what repeats, whether you drop back a cohort).
8. Update systems (student status, timetables, campus card access).
9. Compliance sweep: police registration (if your address changes), CHSI record, any insurance/scholarship documents.

What policies look like (real examples)

- **Peking University:** formal transfer windows in Year one/two, each school sets caps & standards; notices are published with exams/interviews and seat numbers.
- **Shenzhen University:** broadly open; Year one mainly, Year two–three possible; tests by field (STEM → math; arts → subject-specific), with annual seat quotas. Some categories cannot cross (arts/sports, etc.).
- **Zhejiang University of Sci & Tech (ZUST):** one chance in principle; apply by end of each semester; both schools sign; central office re-checks; HSK/credits may trigger downgrade.
- **UIBE/Fujian Med Univ & others:** “not allowed in principle”; exceptions require layered approvals; CSC students must obtain CSC’s letter first.
- **CUHK-Shenzhen (cross-college):** publish explicit GPA/credit thresholds (e.g., $\geq$ B- in gateway credits or GPA $\geq$ 3.0).

Scholarship reality (read before you act)

- **CSC:** “In principle not allowed to change major or study period.” Any exception requires official approvals; unauthorized changes risk cancellation.
- **Other scholarships (university/provincial):** many copy CSC rules; always get written confirmation before you switch.

Consequences to plan for (so you’re not surprised)

- **Extra time & tuition:** cross-field moves often add one/two semesters.
- **New course loads:** heavy make-up workload in the first year after switching.
- **Dorm & admin changes:** some colleges manage their own dorm allocations; expect moves.
- **Internship eligibility:** some majors require early prerequisites, switching late can delay internships.

Red flags (don’t do these)

- Waiting until after the application window. Most schools won’t consider late requests.
- Switching first, telling scholarship later. This can forfeit funding.
- Ignoring CHSI/permit updates. This bites you at graduation/job-check.

One-page checklist (print this)

Before you apply

- Read your school's latest transfer rules & dates.
- Meet target dept. to confirm tests, seats, credits.
- Scholarship status confirmed in writing (CSC needs formal approval).

Apply

- Form plus transcript plus statement/portfolio submitted on time.
- Sit required tests/interviews.

After approval

- Get credit mapping in writing (and any cohort downgrade).
- Update CHSI record once status changes.
- If address/host institution changes: update police registration & Exit-Entry.

Accommodation in China

Finding the right place to live is one of the most important steps for students arriving in China. You will usually begin in a university dormitory, but over time you may wish to move into a serviced apartment or a private apartment for more independence. Each option has different costs, rules, and legal requirements.

1) University Dormitories (On-Campus Housing)

- Availability: Most universities provide on-campus dormitories for international students.
- Cost: Around 1,200 / 4,500 RMB per month, depending on room type (single/double) and facilities.
- What's included: Bed, desk, shared or private bathroom, basic internet access.
- Advantages:
 - This the Cheapest option.
 - Close to classrooms, libraries, and canteens.
 - Utilities are often included.
 - The university registers your residence automatically with the police.
- Disadvantages:
 - Limited privacy (shared rooms are very common).
 - Strict rules (visitor restrictions, curfews, noise limits).
 - Extremely high demand spaces may fill up quickly.

Recommendation: For your first year, the dormitory is the best, easiest and safest choice while you adapt to China.

2) Serviced Apartments

Serviced apartments are a mix of a hotel and a private apartment. They are fully furnished, including regular cleaning, and are managed by professional companies.

- **Cost:** Typically, 10,000 / 30,000 RMB per month for a one-bedroom unit, depending on size and location.
- **Location:** Common in Chaoyang, Dongcheng, and near university areas in Haidian.
- **Included services:**
 - Furniture, kitchen appliances, and bedding.
 - Weekly cleaning and linen change.
 - 24/7 security and front desk service.
 - Maintenance support.
 - Some utilities may be included.
- **Advantages:**
 - Move in immediately with just your suitcase.
 - No need to buy furniture or arrange utilities.
 - Staff often speak English.
 - Flexible lease terms (sometimes 3/6 months).
- **Disadvantages:**
 - More expensive than dorms or private rentals.
 - Less integration with local Chinese communities.

When to choose this option:

- If you want extreme comfort and convenience without dorm restrictions.
- If your budget allows higher rent.
- If you prefer managed housing with fewer responsibilities.

3) Private Apartments (Off-Campus Housing)

If you want maximum independence, you can rent an apartment directly from a landlord or agency.

Popular Areas for Students in Beijing

- **Haidian District:** Close to universities like Tsinghua, Peking University, Beihang.
- **Chaoyang District:** Modern, international, well-connected by metro.
- **Dongcheng / Xicheng Districts:** Central, cultural areas, but more expensive.

Typical rent:

- **Small one-bedroom/studio:** 5,000 / 15,000 RMB per month.
- **Larger apartments (2/3 bedrooms):** 15,000 / 25,000 RMB per month.

How to Rent Legally

1. Search for listings through agencies, university notice boards, or apps (Ziroom/Lianjia).
2. Visit the apartment with the landlord or agent.
3. **Check documents:** landlord's property certificate plus ID.
4. Sign a written lease contract (租房合同). Contracts are usually for one year.
5. Pay deposit (1/2 months' rent) plus first month's rent upfront plus security deposit. Agencies may also charge one month's rent as a service fee.

6. Get official receipts (fapiao 发票). Sometimes needed for visa/residence procedures.
7. Collect the keys and take photos of the apartment's condition and report any damages or notices immediately.
8. Register your address at the local police station within 24 hours. Bring your passport, visa, and contract.
9. Submit the police registration paper to your university's International Office or the International Students Services ISS.

Bills & Utilities

- Normally not included in the rent.
- Electricity, water, gas, and internet cost around 500/900 RMB per month.
- Payments are usually made via WeChat Pay or Alipay apps or at convenience stores.

4) Legal Requirements for All Off-Campus Housing (Serviced or Private)

- **Police Registration:** Mandatory within 24 hours of moving in. Serviced apartments usually handle this for you; with private landlords, you must do it yourself.
- **Lease Contract:** Must include landlord's/company details, your name, rental period, and rent amount.
- **Deposit:** Expect to pay 1/2 months' rent upfront.

5) Practical Tips for Students

- Start in dorms for your first year; move out later if you want more freedom.
- Never live in unregistered housing as this can cause problems for student visa and residence permits.
- Bring a Chinese-speaking friend or university staff when signing contracts.
- Check contract terms carefully, especially for penalties on early cancellation.
- Always keep copies of your rental contract, receipts, and police registration.

6) Summary: Which Option Fits You?

- **Dormitory:** Cheapest, easiest, less private. Best for freshman year or first-year adaptation.
- **Serviced Apartment:** Comfortable, managed, convenient, but higher rent. Best for those who want independence without stress.
- **Private Apartment:** Maximum freedom and choice, but requires more responsibility and legal awareness. Best for senior students or groups sharing.

Academic Life in China

University life in China can be exciting, challenging, and quite different from what students may expect back home. To succeed, you must understand both the hard realities of academic study and the ways to enjoy student life in balance.

1) Language of Instruction

- Most programs are still taught in Mandarin Chinese.
- However, many top universities now offer English-taught programs, especially for international business, engineering, and economics.
- Popular universities for Bahraini students include:
 - Peking University (PKU) one of the top-ranked, research intensive.
 - Tsinghua University is especially strong in engineering, science, and technology.
 - Beijing Language and Culture University (BLCU) is famous for Chinese language programs for foreigners.
- **Tip:** If you are not fluent in Mandarin Chinese language, you may need to take 1/2 years of language study before beginning your degree. Apply early because spots in English programs are limited.

2) Academic Expectations (The Hard Side)

Chinese universities are known for being demanding and structured. Here's what to expect:

- **Attendance is important:** Many professors check attendance, and too many absences may affect your grade or scholarship.
- **Homework & readings:** Expect regular assignments, group projects, and lots of presentations.
- **Exams:** Usually held mid-semester and end-of-semester. They may be written, oral, or practical depending on your field.
- **Graduation projects/theses:** Final-year students often complete a research project, thesis, or design portfolio. This can be stressful but is also your chance to show your knowledge and skills.
- **Plagiarism rules:** Chinese universities are extremely strict about plagiarism and cheating. Work must be your own.

3) How to Succeed (The Easy Way if You Prepare Well)

- **Time management:** Use a calendar to plan study sessions, assignment deadlines, and exams. Balance study with breaks.
- **Study smart:** Focus on understanding concepts, not just memorization. Many professors value critical thinking and participation.
- **Group work:** Teamwork is common in Chinese classrooms. Be active and contribute these builds both grades and friendships.
- **Use campus resources:** Most universities have libraries, language labs, and online portals. Don't ignore them.
- **Ask for help:** Chinese classmates may study differently from you, learn from their methods, and share your own.

4) Balancing Stress and Fun (Mental Health & Social Life)

Studying in China can be intense, but balance is key to long-term success.

- **After exams (mid-terms/finals):** Take time to relax. Popular ways include karaoke (KTV), hotpot with friends, hiking the Great Wall, or day trips around Beijing.
- **During graduation projects:** Plan fun breaks even simple activities like coffee with friends, basketball, or short weekend trips help clear your mind.
- **“Study hard, play harder” mindset:**
 - Work seriously during the week.
 - Reward yourself with fun activities on weekends.
 - This keeps you motivated and avoids burnout.
- **University clubs, students' union & societies:** Join sports teams, cultural clubs, or international student groups. They are a great way to meet people and de-stress.
- **Health & fitness:** Most campuses have gyms and sports facilities. Use them, exercise is the best stress relief.
- **Mental health support:** Larger universities often have counseling centers. Do not hesitate to seek help if you feel overwhelmed.

5) Building a Balanced Routine

Here's a model routine for managing study and fun:

- **Morning:** Classes plus review notes.
- **Afternoon:** Study group, library time, or assignments.
- **Evening (2/3 times a week):** Gym, sports, or student club.
- **Weekend:** Explore Beijing or the city you are in with friends, try new food but don't go extreme ☺ or take a short trip.
- **Before exams:** Study harder, but still take short breaks to relax, eat and sleep well.

6) Key Advice for Freshmen

- Your first year is about adjustment to language, culture, and study methods. Be patient.
- Don't isolate yourself, make both Chinese and international friends.
- Balance is everything. Good grades are important, but so is mental health.
- Explore China. Your university years are not just about classes, they're also about new experiences and personal growth.

Food in China

Food will be one of the biggest adjustments for international students in China. Chinese cuisine is world-famous, but it can also be complicated for newcomers because:

- Pork is the most common meat, often hidden in dumplings, soups, and sauces.
- Alcohol is used in many dishes (rice wine, cooking wine).
- Many dishes are extremely spicy, especially from Sichuan and Hunan provinces.

To enjoy food in China while respecting your own preferences and diet, you must learn how to choose wisely and use the tools available.

1) Eating Out: Options for Every Taste

- **Chinese restaurants:** Offer everything from noodles and dumplings to hotpot. Always ask if a dish contains pork or alcohol.
- **Halal restaurants:** Widely available in Beijing, Shanghai, Xi'an, and most large cities. Look for the Arabic word “清真” (Qīngzhēn) on the sign.
- **International restaurants:** In major cities you can find:
 - Japanese (sushi, ramen),
 - Indian (curries, vegetarian meals),
 - Thai (mild or spicy options),
 - Mexican (tacos, burritos),
 - Italian (pizza, pasta),
 - Western cafés and bakeries (China have excellent bakeries like croissants, bagels, cakes, and coffee are everywhere).
- **University canteens:** Cheap and convenient, but choices may be very limited if you avoid pork.

Useful phrase: “I do not eat pork” 我不吃猪肉 (Wǒ bù chī zhūròu).

2) Ordering Food Online

In China, food delivery is cheap, fast and reliable. Students often order during lunch breaks, after the gym, or late at night.

- **Main apps:**
 - Meituan 美团
 - Ele.me 饿了么
- **How to use them:**
 1. Download the app and connect it to your WeChat Pay or Alipay account.
 2. Enter your address in Chinese (ask a friend or dorm staff to help you the first time).
 3. Filter for Halal 清真 restaurants, vegetarian, or international food.
 4. Pay directly in the app or you can use WeChat app or Alipay app, and your food arrives in 20/40 minutes.

Tip: Always double-check photos and reviews before ordering.

3) Translating Menus in Food Apps

When using Meituan or Ele.me inside WeChat app or Alipay app, most restaurant menus will appear in Chinese. Don't worry, both apps have tools to help you read them in English.

How to translate menus step by step:

1. Open the food app (Meituan or Ele.me) **through WeChat or Alipay “mini programs”**
2. Choose the restaurant you like. The menu will usually be in Chinese.
3. On your phone, **use the built-in translation function:**
 - In WeChat, press and hold on the screen, then select Translate.
 - In Alipay, look for the Translate option in the menu or use the scan/translate feature.
4. The menu will appear in English (sometimes not perfect, but enough to understand).
5. Select the dish, add it to your cart, and pay with WeChat Pay or Alipay.

Tip: Even if the translation is not 100% accurate, photos and customer reviews help you guess what the dish looks like.

4) Buying Groceries & Cooking at Home

Many students prefer cooking their own meals to feel more at home.

- **Supermarkets:** Carrefour, Walmart, Hema (Freshippo by Alibaba), and Metro sell international products and fresh groceries.
- **Halal butchers and shops:** Found in areas with Muslim communities (often near mosques). They sell halal meat, chicken, and lamb.
- **Seafood:** Fresh salmon, shrimp, and fish are available in most big supermarkets.
- **Bakeries & cafés:** Extremely popular in China, you can easily buy bagels, bread, croissants, and pastries for breakfast or snacks.
- **Online groceries:**
 - Order halal meat, vegetables, snacks, and drinks directly from apps like Meituan, JD.com or Hema.
 - Pay with WeChat/Alipay.
 - Delivery is often same-day, sometimes within 30/60 minutes.

5) Drinks & Beverages

- **Coffee:** Widely available at Starbucks, Costa, Luckin Coffee, and small cafés.
- **Tea:** China has hundreds of varieties green tea, oolong, black tea.
- **Milk tea shops:** Very popular with students, but many are sweet and may contain additives.
- **Alcohol:** Read labels carefully; some sauces and dishes contain **Chinese rice wine**.

6) Survival Tips for Food & Drink

- Learn the word 清真 (Halal) and 无猪肉 (No pork).
- Always check ingredients even chicken soups, chicken wraps or dumplings may hide pork.
- Use delivery apps daily they are part of normal student life in China.
- Cook at home when you miss familiar food. Groceries and halal meat as well as the spices are widely available and easy to order online.
- Explore international restaurants when you need variety China's big cities have everything from sushi to tacos to briskets and franchise burgers and many more.
- Balance diet with fresh organic fruits, vegetables, and exercise. University life can be stressful, and eating well helps with both health and mental balance.

Healthcare, Insurance & Staying Well in China

New climate, new food, new routines, your body needs time to adjust. This guide shows you how to stay healthy, what insurance you need, where to go for care, and exactly what to do when you feel unwell.

1) Before You Fly: Prep Checklist (do these at least 2/4 weeks ahead)

Apps to install

- Moji Weather for accurate local weather alerts and seasonal tips.
- IQAir AirVisual to track air quality (AQI) and get health recommendations plus forecasts.

Vaccines & health prep (talk to your doctor in Bahrain before you depart)

- Check CDC/WHO guidance for travelers to China. Typical recommendations include being up to date on influenza, Hepatitis A/B, MMR, Tdap, and (depending on itinerary) typhoid, Japanese encephalitis, rabies. Plan ahead; some vaccines need multiple doses.
- Bring a basic first-aid/comfort kit (thermometer, fever reducer, rehydration salts, throat lozenges, band-aids).
- Pack N95/KN95 masks for high-AQI days especially in winter and crowded public transport.

Clothing & gear (by season/city)

- **Northern cities (e.g., Beijing):** Winters are extremely cold and dry; average January lows are around -20 °C, and severe cold waves can drop below -25 °C. Pack a real winter jacket, thermal layers, gloves, scarf, and lip/skin moisturizer. Summers reach the high 30s °C.
- **Eastern/coastal cities (e.g., Shanghai):** Summers are hot & very humid (July averages near 38 °C); winters are chilly and damp. Pack breathable summer wear plus a rain layer.

About air quality (what to expect)

- China's air quality has improved markedly over the past decade thanks to major controls, but unhealthy days still occur, especially in winter. Use your AQI app, wear a mask on bad days, and ventilate smartly.

2) Health Insurance (non-negotiable)

Is insurance required?

Yes. Chinese universities normally require international students to purchase approved medical insurance, commonly the Comprehensive Insurance Plan for Foreign Students (often provided by Ping An). Typical cost is about 800 RMB/year (or 400 RMB/semester). Your ISS or school will guide you during registration. Keep your e-policy and hotline handy.

If you already have private insurance from home:

- Confirm China coverage, direct billing options, and reimbursement rules before travel.
- Bring claim forms and 24/7 assistance numbers.

3) Where to Get Care (quick map)

A. University / Campus clinic

- Best for minor issues (colds, stomach upsets, simple wounds). Staff can refer you onward.

B. Public “3A” teaching hospitals (top-tier)

- Excellent specialists, widest services; English may be limited. Expect to register queue, pay small fees, then see the doctor. Examples:
 - Peking Union Medical College Hospital (PUMCH), Beijing is renowned national center with International Medical Services IMS.

C. International private hospitals/clinics (English-friendly, direct billing)

- Beijing United Family Hospital (24-hour emergency) and Raffles Hospital Beijing (24/7).
- Shanghai United Family Hospital (multiple campuses, 24-hour emergency) and Jiahui International Hospital (24/7).
- Shanghai East International Medical Center (Pudong, 24-hour line).
- Children’s Hospital of Fudan University (top pediatrics; has international services/consultation halls).

Emergency number (ambulance): 120. Police 110, Fire 119. Calls are free.

4) How to See a Doctor (step-by-step)

If you feel unwell (non-emergency)

1. **Tell a trusted person:** roommate/RA/classmate or the International Students Office or the ISS International Students Services.
2. **Choose where to go** (campus clinic or public hospital or international hospital).
3. **Bring:** passport, student ID, insurance card/e-policy, payment method (WeChat/Alipay/credit card).
4. **Registration (public hospitals):** use the on-site kiosk/desk or WeChat mini-program to register then pay the visit fee and wait for your number.
5. **Pharmacy:** many meds are dispensed on-site after your visit. Keep all receipts for insurance claims.

If it's urgent or severe

- Call 120 immediately or go straight to an ER at an international hospital (English support) or the nearest public hospital.

5) If You Have Insurance vs. If You Don't (yet)

With university-approved insurance

- Follow the provider's instructions (some clinics/hospitals do direct billing; others require you to pay first, claim later).
- Keep original receipts, medical reports, and prescriptions for reimbursement.

No insurance yet / policy pending

- Do not delay care. Go to campus clinic or an international clinic. Pay by card/WeChat and save every receipt.
- Purchase/activate the required student policy as soon as possible; ask if expenses after enrollment can be partially reimbursed (varies by plan).

6) Everyday Prevention: How Not to Get Sick

Weather & seasonal tips

- **Winter (north):** Extremely dry air plus heating equals sore throats and nosebleeds. Use a humidifier, drink lots of water, and always apply lip balm/skin moisturizer.
- **Summer (east & south):** Heat plus humidity, hence, wear breathable clothing, rehydrate, and avoid midday sun.

Flu season

- Influenza typically peaks winter to spring (north); some southern regions can also see summer peaks. Get the flu shot before the season.

Air quality

- Check AQI daily (AirVisual). On unhealthy days: limit intense outdoor exercise, wear an N95/KN95, and **consider an air purifier for your room**. China's PM2.5 has improved overall, but spikes still happen, hence do not ignore alerts.

Food & water

- Wash hands often; when in doubt, choose cooked foods. Due to diet restrictions (e.g., Halal, no alcohol/no pork), always double-check ingredients and use delivery apps' filters to make sure.

7) Finding & Booking Care (digital tools)

- Hospital apps/mini-programs (via WeChat/Alipay) let you: register, pay, see results, and message departments (Chinese UI is common; ask a friend or university staff to help you the first time).
- Large online platforms such as WeDoctor and HaoDF connect patients to hospitals and doctors for appointments or tele-consults.

8) Mental Health & Stress

University life can be intense (midterms, finals, graduation projects).

- Use campus counseling if you feel anxious, depressed, or overwhelmed.
- Keep a balanced routine: make sure you sleep very well, hydrate, regular healthy meals, keep moving (gym/walks), and fun short breaks with friends.

9) What to do at a Glance (print this)

If sick today

- **Minor:** go to the campus clinic then take a rest plus have lots of fluids, then follow-up if no improvement in 48h.
- **Moderate:** you may visit an international clinic or top public hospital (bring passport plus insurance).
- **Severe:** Immediately call 120 / go to ER.

If you need a hospital now (Beijing)

- PUMCH IMS (public, top specialists) or Beijing United Family / Raffles Hospital Beijing (international).

If you need a hospital now (Shanghai)

- Shanghai United Family (multiple sites), Jiahui International Hospital, or SEIMC (Pudong).

Always bring passport • student ID • insurance e-card • phone with WeChat/Alipay • cash/backup card • prior test results.

Notes you can tell students (to correct common myths)

- “China is the most polluted country” that is Not accurate. Air quality varies by city and season and has improved significantly, though unhealthy days still occur, hence use your AQI app and take precautions.

Cultural Etiquette & Communication in China

Moving to China for the very first time can feel overwhelming. The culture is rich, exciting, and very different from Bahrain or Western countries. Knowing the dos and don'ts, how to communicate politely, and how to stay safe will help you adapt quickly and avoid mistakes.

1) Everyday Politeness

- **Greetings:** A smile and a handshake are common in formal settings. Among young people, a simple "Hello" (in English) or "Nǐ hǎo" is enough.
- **Titles matter:** Call professors "Teacher" (Lǎoshī) or "Professor." Avoid using first names unless invited to do so.
- **Politeness style:** The Chinese value respect a lot, patience, and humility. Speaking too loudly, showing anger in public, or criticizing openly may be seen as rude.

2) Social Life & Communication

- **WeChat is essential:** It's your main app for chatting, making payments, joining class groups, and even calling taxis. Download it before you arrive in China if possible "preferably use Chinese Mobile number to avoid many restrictions on the app".
- **Adding contacts:** Use the QR code scanner to add friends, classmates, and professors.
- **Group chats:** Every class, dorm, and activity will have a WeChat group. Always read carefully and avoid spamming.
- **Language barrier:** Do not be embarrassed if your Chinese is limited. Many students and young people know some English. Use translation apps (WeChat has built-in translation or built in Apple translator).

3) Understanding Chinese Culture (the good and the challenging)

- **The good:**
 - Safe, orderly, and convenient (transport, payments, delivery).
 - People in China are generally curious and friendly towards international students so they might just stop you to take a picture with you and that is absolutely no worries about it.
- **The challenging:**
 - Pork and alcohol are common in Chinese food always ask and double-check.
 - Spicy food can be overwhelming; ask for no or less spice (Bù yào là).
 - People may stare at you out of curiosity, especially in smaller cities it's usually harmless.
 - Personal space may feel smaller than what you are used to.

- **Strong respect for education:**
 - In China, education is considered one of the most important values in society. Families often invest heavily in their children's studies, and students are expected to work very hard.
 - Professors and teachers are treated with great respect, in China students usually listen quietly, take notes carefully, and rarely challenge the teacher openly in class.
 - Grades and performance are taken seriously; Chinese classmates may spend long hours in the library or study rooms.
 - For international students, this means you will be studying in an environment where people are highly focused and disciplined, which can motivate you to stay on track.
 - At the same time, remember to respect your professors a lot by being punctual, prepared, proactive and very polite, this is seen as a sign of good character.

4) Safety & Security in Daily Life

- **China is extremely safe.** Violent crime is exceedingly rare, and you will often see people walking alone late at night.
- **Surveillance cameras:** You will notice cameras everywhere (streets, buses, subway, campus). This is normal in China and part of why the streets feel secure.
- **Walking at night:** In cities like Beijing or Shanghai, it is safe to walk around even at midnight. Still, use common sense:
 - Stay in well-lit areas.
 - Avoid noticeably quiet alleys.
 - Walk with friends if possible.
- **When to panic and when not to:**
 - Do not panic if people stare at you, it is usually curiosity.
 - Do not panic if you see many cameras, it is for safety.
 - Stay calm if you get lost or miss your bus/train; there are many ways to find help in China.
 - Only panic (**and call for help immediately**) if someone "physically" bothers you or you have severe medical emergency.

5) What to Do if You Get Lost (and Your Phone is Dead)

1. Carry a small card with your university name and address written in Chinese. Hand it to a taxi driver or ask a passerby.
2. Look for a police officer (jǐngchá) or a security guard (bǎo'ān). Show them your card or passport.
3. Go into a convenience store (7-Eleven, FamilyMart, Lawson) and ask the cashier to help you find your way.
4. Don't be afraid to ask for help. In China even if people don't speak English, they will try to assist you.

Tip: Always carry a small power bank so your phone doesn't die outside.

6) Golden Rules for New Students

- Always be polite, even if frustrated.
- Learn a few survival phrases in Chinese:
 - “I don’t understand” Wǒ tīng bù dǒng
 - “Help me” Bāng wǒ
 - “Where is...?” zài nǎlǐ?
- Never argue loudly in public; it will only embarrass you and the other person.
- Respect local traditions (e.g., avoid political discussions, don’t insult Chinese culture).
- Keep your passport safe; carry a photocopy or photo on your phone.

7) Key Takeaway for Freshmen Student

China is one of the safest countries in the world for students, but it is also very structured and different from what you may know. If you:

- Stay polite,
- Learn to use WeChat,
- Carry your address card, and
- Keep calm when things go wrong,

...you will adapt quickly and enjoy both your studies and your free time with confidence.

Important Documents for Students in China

As a new student in China, your documents are your identity, legal protection, and access to services. You must keep them safe, know what they are used for, and understand the rules around them.

1) Passport (Hùzhào) Your Main ID in China

- Your passport is your identity in China. Unlike Bahrain or other countries where you can use a national ID card or the CPR, foreigners in China must use their passport for almost everything.
- You will need to show the physical passport (not just a copy) when:
 - Entering tourist attractions (e.g., Forbidden City, Great Wall, Disney, Universal Studios, zoos, museums).
 - Booking and boarding trains, planes, or long-distance buses.
 - Checking into hotels or serviced apartments.
 - Opening a bank account, buying a SIM card, or registering at hospitals.
 - Completing university and visa paperwork.
 - Police check points and every governmental entity you approach

Important: A digital copy or phone photo will not be accepted in most cases.

Keeping Your Passport Safe

Since you must carry your passport often, learn how to protect it like treasure:

- Use a passport cover or wallet to keep it clean and waterproof.
- Carry it in a secure place (zippered bag or inner pocket). Do not put it in your back pocket where it can fall or be stolen.
- Keep a photocopy and digital copy (on your phone plus cloud storage). If you lose it, these copies help with replacement.
- Do not hand it over casually only give it to officials, ticket counters, or hotel staff when necessary.
- At night or in your dorm/apartment: store it in a locked drawer or a small safe.

If You Lose Your Passport

1. Stay calm.
2. Report the loss to the local police immediately and get a loss certificate.
3. Inform your university's International Students Office or the ISS.
4. Contact Embassy of The Kingdom of Bahrain in Beijing for emergency replacement.
5. Apply for a new Residence Permit once you have a new passport.

2) Visa

- Visa (usually X1 or X2): This is the entry visa stamped in your passport by the Chinese Embassy before you travel. It allows you to enter China legally.
- You will later convert your visa into a Residence Permit (see below).

3) Student ID Card

- Issued by your university after registration.
- Uses:
 - Proof that you are a student.
 - Access to libraries, dormitories, classrooms, and sports facilities.
 - Payment card for canteens and campus shops (in many universities).
 - Discounts on trains, buses, museums, and some attractions.

Tip: Always carry it in your wallet, it saves both money and time.

4) Residence Permit

- **What it is:** The legal document stamped into your passport that replaces your entry visa. It allows you to stay in China for the length of your studies.
- **Deadline:** You must apply within 30 days of arrival in China. Your university's International Students Office or the International Students Services ISS will guide you.
- **Steps:**
 1. Complete your health check.
 2. Register your address at the police station (or confirm with your dorm/landlord).
 3. Submit documents (passport, admission letter, health report, photos, registration form) at the Exit-Entry Bureau.
 4. Pay the fee (approx. 400 - 800 RMB).
 5. Wait 2 - 4 weeks for processing. You may receive a temporary receipt to carry while it's being processed.

Tip: Never miss this deadline, overstaying your visa/permit can lead to heavy fines or even deportation.

5) Health Records & Vaccination Card

- Bring a translated copy (English) of your health and vaccination record from home.
- Required for:
 - Health check procedures.
 - Some dormitories or universities.
 - Medical care if you get sick.
- Vaccinations often required or recommended for students include MMR, Hepatitis A & B, Tdap, influenza, and sometimes typhoid/Japanese encephalitis (check before arrival).

6) Police Registration Form

- Every student must register their place of residence within 24 hours of arrival in a new place:
 - Hotels and dorms usually do this automatically.
 - If you rent an apartment, you (with your landlord) must go to the local police station.
- You'll get a Registration Form of Temporary Residence. Keep it safe, it is required for your Residence Permit application.

7) Insurance Card / Policy

- Proof of your student health insurance (usually provided by the university).
- Shows your policy number, hotline, and coverage.
- Needed for hospital visits or reimbursement.

8) Bank Card (after you open a Chinese account)

- Issued after you open a local bank account (often mandatory for postpaid SIM or dorm payments).
- Needed for:
 - Paying tuition.
 - Linking to WeChat/Alipay for daily expenses.
 - Receiving refunds or scholarship stipends.

9) How to Keep Documents Safe

- **Carry daily:** student ID, residence registration paper.
- **Store at home unless needed:** original passport, residence permit, health records, insurance papers.
- Keep digital backups of all documents in cloud storage (Google Drive, iCloud).
- Use a document folder to organize everything, you will be asked for the same papers many times.

10) If You Lose a Document (What To Do)

- **Residence Permit:** Go to International Students Office or ISS then Exit-Entry Bureau for replacement.
- **Student ID:** Report to your university and request re-issue.
- **Bank card:** Freeze via app/phone or hotline then go to the bank with your passport to replace.

11) Quick Freshman Checklist (print and keep in dorm)

- ☒ Passport valid plus visa page inside.
- ☒ Student ID card.
- ☒ Residence permit application submitted within 30 days.
- ☒ Police registration form safe.
- ☒ Health record plus vaccination copy.
- ☒ Insurance policy/card.
- ☒ Bank card (once opened).
- ☒ Copies & digital backups of everything.

Bahrain Embassy in Beijing, China

Address:

10-06, Liangmaqiao Diplomatic Residence Compound,
No. 22, Dong Fang Dong Lu, Chaoyang District,
Beijing 100600, China

Email: beijing.mission@mofa.gov.bh

Fax: (+86) 10 6532 6393

Phone: (+86) 10 6532 6483, 5

Website: www.mofa.gov.bh/beijing/Home.aspx

When Should You Contact the Embassy?

As a Bahraini student, the Embassy is your safest point of help in emergencies. You should contact them if:

- You lose your passport. Report to local police first, then contact the embassy for a replacement, the consulate affairs department will guide you through.
- You are arrested or face legal issues. The Embassy can provide consular support and contact your family.
- You are hospitalized in a serious emergency. The Embassy can help with translation, communication with family, and support.
- You face harassment or threats. Report to police first, then inform the embassy.
- You are caught in a natural disaster or crisis (earthquake, pandemic restrictions, flood).
- You need to verify official documents for university or government procedures.
- General inquires.

Registration with Bahrain Cultural Office BCO

Who must register?

Every Bahraini student in mainland China, freshmen and seniors, degree or language program must register. This is not a formality; it is essential for your safety, support, and legal readiness.

Why is this critical (what the office does for you)

- **Emergency alerts & check-ins:** Fast contact during crises (severe weather, public-health measures, campus incidents).
- **Medical & hospital liaison:** Guidance, language support, and contact with your family if you're admitted.
- **Lost passport / legal issues:** Priority consular help and step-by-step instructions.
- **Academic & admin support:** Letters/verification for universities, banks, housing, and local authorities when needed.
- **Travel advisories & safety notices:** City-specific updates (AQI spikes, transport disruptions, holiday closures).
- **Census & care:** The office runs quarterly reviews of the student database to keep your information current so help reaches you immediately when it matters.

What you need to submit (complete and accurate)

1. Full name (as in passport) plus CPR/ Bahrain National ID.
2. Passport details (number, issue/expiry dates) plus clear photo/scan of the bio page.
3. China visa type (X1/X2) and Residence Permit info (once issued).
4. University & program (name, college/department, major), student ID, academic advisor contacts details.
5. Current China address (dorm/apt plus room no.) and police registration form number (once obtained).
6. Chinese mobile number, email, WeChat ID (primary way to reach you).
7. Emergency contacts (parents/guardian names, phones, emails) and consent to contact them if needed.
8. Medical notes you wish to share for emergencies (allergies, medications, chronic conditions).
9. Insurance policy (provider, policy number, 24/7 hotline).

How to register (choose one)

- Online/WeChat form (if a link/QR is provided by the Cultural Office).
- Email the Cultural Office via the embassy address with subject line:

“Student Registration – [Full Name] – [University] – [City]”

Attach the items above as PDFs/photos.

- In person at the Embassy/Cultural Office (bring passport and student papers).

Copy-paste email template:

Subject: Student Registration – [Full Name] – [University] – [City]

Dear Cultural Office Team at the Embassy of The Kingdom of Bahrain,

Please find my details for registration:

- Full Name (As in Passport):
- CPR/ Bahrain National ID:
- Passport No. / Expiry date:
- Visa Type / Residence Permit No. & Expiry date:
- University name / College / Major / Student ID number:
- China Address (Dorm/Apt plus Room No):
- Police Registration No:
- China Mobile No:
- Email:
- WeChat ID:
- Insurance Provider / Policy No. / Hotline:
- Emergency Contacts (Name/Relation/Phone/Email):
- Medical Notes for Emergencies (optional):

Attachments: Passport bio page, visa/permit page, student ID, insurance card/policy.

I consent to be contacted for safety alerts and emergencies.

Kind regards,

[Full Name]

When to update your record (notify within 48 hours)

- New address, phone number, or WeChat ID.
- New passport or residence permit (renewal/replacement).
- Change of university/major, leave of absence, or graduation.
- Hospitalization, serious incident, or police report filed.
- Travel out of China for more than 30 days.

How your data is used

- **Purpose:** Consular protection, emergency response, and student services.
- **Sharing:** Only with relevant authorities in emergencies or when legally required.
- **Security:** Maintained by the Embassy/Cultural Office; reviewed quarterly to keep it current.

Important distinctions

- Embassy/Cultural Office registration ≠ Police residence registration.

You must complete both (police registration within 24 hours of moving; Cultural Office registration as soon as you arrive/enroll).

Quick checklist (print & tick)

- ☒ Submitted Cultural Office registration (email/online/in person).
- ☒ Saved Embassy & Cultural Office phone plus email in phone and on paper.
- ☒ Consented to receive alerts (WeChat/SMS/email).
- ☒ Set reminder to update details after any change.

Holidays in China: What Every International Student Must Know

Holidays in China are more than just days off, they are deeply tied to Chinese culture, family life, and national pride. For international students, holidays are a time to rest, explore, and connect, but also a time to plan carefully.

1) Types of Holidays in China

- **National Holidays:** Official days off for everyone (schools, banks, businesses close).
- **Traditional Festivals:** Rooted in Chinese culture, often with special foods, gifts, or customs.
- **University Holidays:** Winter and summer breaks (linked to semester schedules).
- **International Holidays:** Christmas, New Year's Eve, etc., are not official, but celebrated in cities.

2) Major Holidays to Know

Spring Festival / Chinese New Year

- **When:** January/February (based on lunar calendar).
- **Length:** 1 week official, but in reality, 2-3 weeks of closures.
- **What it means:** Family reunion, fireworks, red envelopes (hóngbāo), and massive travel (world's largest migration).
- **Student tips:**
 - Expect crowded trains, buses, and airports, hence book travel weeks in advance.
 - Many shops/restaurants close, but tourist attractions remain open.
 - If staying in China, join friends for traditional dinners or travel to quieter destinations.

Qingming Festival (Tomb Sweeping Day)

- **When:** Early April.
- **Length:** 3 days.
- **What it means:** Families clean ancestors' graves and honor them.
- **Student tips:**
 - Some businesses close; travel is possible.
 - Good chance to see cultural traditions up close.

Dragon Boat Festival (Duānwǔ Jié)

- **When:** June.
- **Length:** 3 days.
- **What it means:** Dragon boat races, eating zòngzi (sticky rice wrapped in bamboo leaves).
- **Student tips:**
 - Great cultural experience to attend a local boat race.
 - Less crowded than Chinese New Year.

Mid-Autumn Festival (Zhōngqiū Jié)

- **When:** September/October.
- **Length:** 3 days.
- **What it means:** Families gather to admire the full moon and exchange mooncakes (yuèbǐng).
 - Mooncakes are round pastries filled with lotus seed paste, red bean, nuts, or salted egg yolk.
 - They symbolize unity and reunion.
- **Student tips:**
 - Try different mooncakes with classmates, it's a fun bonding activity.
 - Expect gift-giving (mooncake boxes are beautifully packaged).

National Day Golden Week (Guóqìng Jié)

- **When:** October 1st.
- **Length:** 8 days (sometimes longer).
- **What it means:** Celebration of the founding of the People's Republic of China (1949).
- **Student tips:**
 - One of the busiest travel weeks in China (similar to Spring Festival).
 - Book tickets early if you plan to explore.
 - Expect parades, fireworks, and patriotic events.

3) University Semester Breaks

- **Winter Break:** Usually January/February, around Spring Festival (4-6 weeks).
- **Summer Break:** Usually July/August (6-8 weeks).
- **Tip:** Use these for travel, internships, or trips back to Bahrain.

4) International & Religious Holidays

- **Christmas & New Year's Eve:** Not official, but big cities decorate malls, cafés, and streets.
- **Eid al-Fitr & Eid al-Adha:** Not national holidays, but major mosques in cities (like Niujie Mosque in Beijing) host prayers and gatherings. Students should plan time off with their university in advance.
- **Other foreign holidays (Valentine's, Halloween):** Celebrated in big cities through restaurants, cafes, and student union clubs.

5) What to Do During Holidays

- **Go home:** If flights are affordable, holidays are a good chance to visit family.
- **Stay on campus:** Catch up on rest, study, or prepare for exams.
- **Travel inside China:** Explore natural wonders (Zhangjiajie mountains, Guilin rivers, Yunnan villages).
- **Cultural exploration:** Join local holiday activities like dragon boat races, lantern festivals, tea ceremonies.
- **Shopping festivals:**
 - Singles' Day (11.11 - November 11th): The world's biggest online shopping day (like Black Friday in western countries).
 - 618 Shopping Festival (June 18th): Huge e-commerce discounts.

6) Holiday Survival Tips

- Always mark holiday dates in your calendar at the start of the semester.
- For big travel weeks (Spring Festival & Golden Week), book trains/planes early as tickets sell out fast.
- Keep snacks and essentials at home, as some shops may close during holidays.
- Use holidays wisely, balance fun, travel, and study.
- Remember, holidays equal opportunity to explore China, bond with friends, and recharge.

After Graduation:

What Every Student Must Do Before Leaving China

Graduating is an exciting moment, but do not rush home without completing the required steps. If you leave China without the proper documents and verifications, you may face serious problems later when applying for jobs, further studies, or government verifications in The Kingdom of Bahrain.

Think of this as your final checklist before boarding your flight back home.

1) Collect All Graduation Documents

- Graduation Certificate (Xuéwèi Zhèngshū) your official diploma.
- Final Academic Transcript (Chéngjī Dān) detailed record of all your grades.
- Recommendation Letters (optional, but useful for future studies/jobs).
- Completion Certificate (if applicable for short-term or non-degree programs).

Tip: Always request multiple originals or at least certified stamped copies. Universities will not mail these to you abroad.

2) Verify Your Qualifications with CHSI

- **What is CHSI?** China Higher Education Student Information (Xuéxìn Wǎng) is the official database of all degrees in China.
- **Why it matters:** Employers, embassies, and the Ministry of Education back in the Kingdom of Bahrain often cross-check your degree here. If your data is missing or inconsistent, your degree may be rejected.
- **Steps:**
 1. Log into the CHSI website or app (your university can guide you).
 2. Verify that your name, passport number, and degree appear correctly.
 3. If you used an old passport during admission, upload scans of old plus new passports to avoid mismatches.
 4. If you see errors (wrong spelling, missing data), contact both your university registrar and CHSI support immediately.

3) Ensure Personal Data Consistency

- Make sure the following matches across all documents:
 - Full name (as in your current passport).
 - Date of birth.
 - Passport number (old and new).
 - Student ID and university record.
- Even a small spelling error (e.g., Sultan vs. Sultaan) can cause problems later in degree recognition.

4) Cancel or Close Local Accounts (to avoid legal/financial problems)

- **University accounts:** library, dormitory deposits, and campus cards.
- **Bank account:** close your Chinese bank account if you don't plan to use it. Keep the closure certificate.
- **SIM card:** cancel your Chinese mobile plan. If left unpaid, it can cause problems if you return later.
- **Rental contracts:** if living in a private apartment, settle bills and get your deposit back.

5) Immigration & Visa Matters

- Your Residence Permit usually expires soon after graduation.
- You must:
 - Either leave China before the expiry date, or
 - Apply for a short-term stay visa if you need extra time to finish procedures.
- Do not overstay as fines and bans can apply.

6) Register Your Graduation with Bahrain Cultural Office

- **Before leaving China**, inform the Bahraini Cultural Office at the (Embassy in Beijing) that you have graduated.
- **Submit:**
 - Copy of your diploma, transcript, and CHSI verification.
 - Your updated contact information (phone, email, home address in Bahrain).
- **Why this is important:**
 - The Cultural Office maintains a national record of all Bahraini students.
 - It simplifies your degree recognition in Bahrain.
 - It ensures you remain in the embassy database in case future verifications or emergencies arise.

7) Keep Digital & Hard Copies (Forever!)

- Scan all documents (diplomas, transcripts, CHSI verification, recommendation letters).
- Save copies in cloud storage (Google Drive, iCloud) plus an external USB drive.
- Keep at least one hard copy folder with originals and certified copies.

8) After You Return to Bahrain

- Submit your degree and CHSI verification to the Ministry of Education in the Kingdom of Bahrain for official recognition.
- If applying for jobs, provide certified copies rather than risking your originals.
- Stay in touch with fellow graduates and the embassy as they often provide networking opportunities for alumni.

9) Quick “Do Not Forget” Checklist

- ☒ Collect diploma plus transcript.
- ☒ Verify qualifications on CHSI (old & new passport numbers included).
- ☒ Correct all errors in name/ID before leaving.
- ☒ Close bank account plus SIM card.
- ☒ Register graduation with Bahraini Cultural Office.
- ☒ Scan everything, save digitally plus keep hard copies.
- ☒ Plan departure before visa/residence expiry.

Common Issues with CHSI and How to Avoid Them

CHSI is the only official platform where your Chinese degree is recorded. Employers, embassies, and Bahrain's Ministry of Education all check CHSI to confirm that your degree is valid.

If your CHSI record is wrong or incomplete, it can create serious problems:

- Your degree may not be recognized.
- Job offers can be delayed or canceled.
- Embassy or Ministry verification may fail.
- Fixing the problem after you leave China can take months (or years).

The Most Common CHSI Problems for Bahraini Students

1. Delayed or Missing Upload by the University
 - Some universities are slow in uploading graduation data.
 - Sometimes data is uploaded months later, or not at all, unless the student follows up.
2. ID Mismatch (Passport or Name Errors)
 - Spelling mistakes in your English name (e.g., "Sultan" vs. "Sultaan").
 - Wrong date of birth or incomplete details.
3. Changed Passport During Study
 - Many students renew their passports during their time in China.
 - CHSI may still show the old passport number used during admission.
 - If your new passport number is missing, Bahrain's Ministry of Education or your employer may reject the verification.
4. Multiple Records
 - If you studied Chinese language first and then a degree program, sometimes CHSI creates two separate profiles that don't link properly.

How to Avoid These Problems (While Still in China)

- Check CHSI before you leave China. Log in and confirm that your record shows:
 - Correct name spelling (in English and Chinese).
 - Correct passport number(s) both old and new if applicable.
 - Correct date of birth.
 - Correct degree name, major, and graduation date.
- If you changed passports:
 - Submit copies of both old and new passports to your university registrar and CHSI.
 - Ask them to update your file immediately.
- If you see mistakes:
 - Contact your university's International Students Office or the ISS as well as the registrar's office.
 - If no action is taken, email CHSI directly and copy the Bahraini Cultural Office in Beijing.
- Before graduation: Ask your university for a CHSI verification printout as this is the document you'll need in The Kingdom of Bahrain.

If You Already Graduated and Find a Problem Later

- Don't panic, but fixing it from outside China is much harder.
- Contact:
 1. Your university's registrar (email plus phone).
 2. CHSI customer support (English support is available by email).
 3. The Bahraini Cultural Office in Beijing they can offer help pushing the university or CHSI to act.

⚠ Warning for students: Every year, Bahraini graduates contact the Embassy of the Kingdom of Bahrain in panic because they cannot get their degree recognized due to CHSI mismatches. This often happens 1-3 years after graduation, when they apply for jobs or government recognition. By then, fixing it is extremely harder and stressful.

Golden Rules for CHSI Success

-  Use the same name spelling everywhere (passport, university, CHSI).
-  Keep old passports safe as you may need them years later.
-  Register new passport numbers with your university and CHSI immediately.
-  Never leave China without checking your CHSI record at least twice.
-  Save a PDF copy of your CHSI verification report before leaving.

“May your pursuit of knowledge be steadfast, your ambitions noble, and your actions guided by the wisdom you gain. Remember, the true honor of learning lies not only in achievement, but in using what you know for the good of others. Go forth as a bearer of light, and may success walk beside you in all your paths.”